everyone.

I smiled and said, "It seems like a very comfortable prison/' and my acquaintance looked unhappy.

A person came down to interview me at 2:00 p.m. He was bald, had red-rimmed eyes, and while not actually drooling, spoke moistly. I disliked him intensely on sight.

He did not apologize for the delay and began by explaining he had no place for me, since bacteriology was required, which I did not have, and since times were getting harder. Why he couldn't have told me this at 10:00 a.m., or why he consented to an appointment at all, I don't know.

I gave him a copy of my dissertation the instant he appeared and some days later he sent it back in the mail, referring to it as "your little brochure" as though he didn't know a doctoral dissertation when he saw one.

I have never forgotten and never will forget Charles Pfizer's. I have since, on occasion, received letters from people at Pfizer's asking for my co-operation in one way or another. As long as the request is on official company stationery, I simply do not answer. It's childish of me, of course, but there's no way in which I can guarantee never being childish.

3

Looking back on it, I think that incident on February 4, 1949, represented the low point of my career, with both chemistry and writing seeming to be at the nadir.

The very next day I met the future and, of course, didn't know it.

At a meeting of the Hydra Club on February 5, I met the editor in charge of Doubleday's new science-fiction program. He was Walter I. Bradbury, an intelligent and kindly man who, in my eyes, looked exactly like the British actor Leo Genn. He was, at that time, thirty-four years old.

He told me he had read "The Mule" and had liked it, but that everything must go through an editorial committee (as is indeed true at Doubleday, even for this book).

As always in such cases, I labored to keep my hopes low, for I dread disappointment. I was right to do so in this case, for nothing